Jaya Harsha Thippana

Principal Data Scientist | AI, experimentation & team leadership

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Principal Data Scientist with experience leading research, production machine learning and customer-facing science. At Vizit, lead R&D and Data Science, report directly to the CEO and lead a team of five. Work combines technical depth with scientific strategy, experimentation, hiring and mentorship, and collaboration with product and engineering.

Earlier experience includes production ML for financial services, building the data science function at Harley-Davidson, computer-vision research at the University of Oklahoma and software development at Pyro Group.

VIZIT | APR 2025 - PRESENT

Principal Data Scientist

Mar 2026 - Present | Boston, MA

Research, team leadership & production delivery

- Lead R&D and Data Science and report directly to the CEO. Set scientific direction and connect research priorities to product and customer needs.
- Lead a team of five data scientists; responsibilities include hiring, mentorship, scientific review and delivery prioritization.
- Guide visual-AI research and evaluation and partner with product and engineering to carry scientific decisions through production delivery.
- Represent the science with enterprise customers, explaining methodology, assumptions and the limits of available evidence.
- Used randomized controlled trials during evaluation of a scoring change to assess its impact and build confidence in rollout decisions.

Staff Data Scientist, Ecommerce

Sep 2025 - Mar 2026 | Boston, MA

Causal inference & customer-facing data science

- Scaled customer impact studies using difference-in-differences and experiment design, from analysis through direct customer presentations.
- Delivered 60 impact studies and automated 5,000+ analyst hours through self-serve dashboards and repeatable analysis.
- Built analytics and reporting that helped commercial teams and customers understand evidence and make decisions.

Senior Ecommerce Data Scientist

Apr 2025 - Sep 2025 | Boston, MA

Research & applied evaluation

- Worked across research and client-facing data science, including model evaluation and analytics for ecommerce imagery.

Reported career outcomes describe distinct initiatives and are not combined into a cumulative impact figure.

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CURRICULUM VITAE / CONTINUED

EARLIER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Northwestern Mutual

Dec 2021 - Apr 2025 | Boston, MA

Senior Data Scientist

- Built and deployed production ML for disability claims. An XGBoost processing pipeline reduced claim decision time by 75%.
- Worked on language-model extraction of medical terminology from handwritten claim forms.
- Built a financial-representative churn model associated with $15M+ in annual savings, separate from the claims initiative.
- Developed reusable modeling methods and an internal Python package; managed junior analysts and data scientists and connected model results to business decisions.

Harley-Davidson Motor Company

Aug 2019 - Dec 2021 | Milwaukee, WI

Data Scientist

- First data science hire; helped build the function and led data scientists and analysts reporting insights directly to executives.
- Built prospect-identification models associated with $35M in annualized revenue; worked with marketing and product on customer journeys.
- Created customer intelligence spanning NLP-based sentiment, desirability, lifetime value, and lead and retention scores.

University of Oklahoma

Mar 2018 - Jun 2019 | Oklahoma

Data Scientist (Intern to Data Scientist)

- Developed a research pipeline for classifying breast masses in digital mammograms, including preprocessing, feature selection, cross-validation, tuning and interpretability.
- Built Python data pipelines and classification models for gray-market device detection. Graduate teaching assistant for Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining.

Pyro Group

Jun 2016 - Jul 2017 | Hyderabad, India

Java Developer

- Developed dynamic web applications using agile scrum; received the Best Employee award for design and development.

METHODS, TOOLS & EDUCATION

Methods: Causal inference, RCTs, A/B testing, difference-in-differences, experiment design, computer vision, representation learning, NLP, generative AI and imbalanced learning.

Tools: Python, SQL, XGBoost, ONNX, AWS, Snowflake, production ML pipelines, model deployment and monitoring, reusable Python packages.

Education: M.S. Computer Science, University of Oklahoma; B.Tech Computer Science, Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University. **Languages:** English, Hindi, Telugu.